



Optiv Consulting

[formerly part of Optiv Security]

Welcome to **Optiv Consulting!**

Your Career in Cyber Strategy Consulting

S e p t e m b e r 2 0 2 6 . V I T

C o n f i d e n t i a l





01

Case Study-1

Vendor AI Usage Analysis.





Introduction to *Case Study-1*

B A C K G R O U N D

Meridian Financial.

Meridian is a global enterprise that relies on a broad portfolio of third-party vendors across cloud, software, and managed services. Artificial intelligence is increasingly embedded into commercial products, and a growing number of these vendors deliver AI capabilities without formally disclosing it.

Meridian's Third-Party Risk Management team needs a dependable way to determine whether a vendor is leveraging AI as part of the services it provides, and to understand what that means for its data, operations and risk posture. Optiv has been engaged to design a repeatable, evidence-driven approach.

As part of a vendor due diligence initiative, the firm has engaged Optiv to design a repeatable, evidence-driven approach built on the vendor's public footprint

P R O B L E M S T A T E M E N T

Read the public footprint.

Optiv must design a method that examines a vendor's public footprint to determine whether the vendor genuinely uses AI in the services it provides, rather than referencing AI as marketing commentary.

- A central part of the challenge is to identify which open-source intelligence (OSINT) sources can be leveraged to reveal real AI usage, and to reason about how much evidentiary weight each source carries.
- The method should classify each signal, apply transparent tags that reflect evidentiary strength, and preserve source traceability so findings remain explainable and repeatable
- Where AI usage is confirmed, it should surface the resulting risks to Meridian, such as exposure of sensitive data to AI models, reliance on undisclosed AI sub-processors, and reduced transparency over how decisions affecting Meridian are made

Your *Roles & Responsibilities*

01 Determine criticality

Judge how critical each vendor is from the profile provided, and define the criteria behind that judgement (sensitivity of data accessed, involvement in payment flows, regulatory exposure, operational dependency, volume of customer data) clearly enough that another analyst would arrive at the same rating.

02 Set the depth

Decide how much assessment depth each level of criticality warrants: which OSINT sources are worth consulting for a critical vendor, which add little for one that is not, and where further investigation stops repaying the effort.

03 Identify the sources

Identify the OSINT sources (vendor product documentation, technical job postings, developer references, regulatory or disclosure filings) that reveal whether AI is genuinely used within the services provided, leveraging AI based techniques.

04 Build the capability

Scrape, extract and analyze information from those sources, classify each signal, apply transparent tags, and summarize how the vendor might be using AI, while preserving source traceability.

05 Surface the risk

Where AI usage is confirmed, surface the resulting risks to Meridian (sensitive data exposed to AI models, reliance on undisclosed AI sub-processors) to support the vendor due diligence process.

Note: A list of vendors with sample or expected outcomes will be shared.



Expected *Outcomes*

A PowerPoint (.pptx) deck covering the sections below, to be walked through with the stakeholder in 10 to 15 minutes.

01 Functional Design Diagram

Walkthrough of the solution design with a Functional Design Diagram showing components and data flow, from OSINT source collection to risk output.

02 Architecture Diagram

Detailed Architecture Diagram that demonstrates different technical components within each functional component and their interactions within the system.

03 Source Strategy

A defined approach to identifying/prioritizing OSINT sources and the evidentiary weight logic.

04 Criticality Ratings

A rating for every vendor, the criteria that produced it, and the depth each rating warrants.

05 Working Demonstration

Demonstration of the workable solution using GoogleColab, Jupyter Notebook, or a simple custom UI. The solution should allow users to upload provided vendors list of Meridian, analyze them and classify the AI Security risk for each vendor.

SUBMISSION

- A team submission, with approximately three weeks from the date of release.
- Keep your findings inside the provided offline excel file no need for the submission. No public repository, no published presentation, no contact with the vendors.



02

Case Study-2

Text Analysis and PII Detection.





Introduction to *Case Study-2*

B A C K G R O U N D

Cadence.

Cadence is a global financial services firm headquartered in New York, offering investment banking, asset management, and consumer banking across the Americas, Europe, and Asia.

Employees across the firm rely on a document analysis agent to review and interpret business documents supporting day-to-day operations and decision-making.

Under a recent organizational policy, personally identifiable information (PII) is restricted from being processed by AI models. Document content is therefore required to be stripped of PII before it is passed to the LLM for processing and analysis.

P R O B L E M S T A T E M E N T

PII within artifact detection.

Optiv must develop a solution capable of detecting Personally Identifiable Information (PII) embedded within the varied evidence artifacts Cadence submits for control evaluation.

- Documents submitted for analysis take varied forms, including scanned policy documents, organizational PowerPoint presentations, and process documents
- PII detection is required to remain precise and consistent, with minimal false positives and no unidentified instances passed downstream.
- The objective is to design and implement a repeatable, scalable system that extracts text from each file format, identifies and classifies the PII within, and redacts it prior to LLM processing.

Your *Roles & Responsibilities*

01 File Structure Analysis

Analyze the structure of the provided sample set of documents provided and determine the appropriate text extraction approach for each, file type

02 Develop the Solution

Develop a solution to extract text from the identified formats, detect and classify PII entities within the extracted content, apply transparent tags, and summarize what PII was found, while preserving source traceability so findings remain explainable and repeatable.

03 Surface the exposure

Surface the resulting PII exposure to Cadence where personal data is identified (such as employee identifiers, full names, contact details, government-issued IDs etc.,) to support the internal audit process and keep PII from reaching the AI model.

Note: A set of sample input files will be shared along with this case study.



Expected *Outcomes*

A PowerPoint (.pptx) deck covering the sections below, to be walked through with the stakeholder in 10 to 15 minutes.

01 Solution Blueprint

Walkthrough of the solution design with a Functional Design Diagram showing components and data flow, from file ingestion to PII detection output.

02 System Architecture

Detailed Architecture Diagram that demonstrates the different technical components within each functional component and their interactions within the system.

03 Extraction Logic

A defined approach to extracting text across the different file formats and the detection logic used to identify and classify PII entities.

04 Reliable Outcomes

Extracted text is expected to retain no less than 80% of its original structure, with preceding and succeeding context preserved. PII detection is expected to approach 100% coverage, thereby limiting exposure of sensitive data to downstream processing by an AI model.

05 Live Walkthrough

Demonstration of the workable solution using any IDE such as Google Colab, Jupyter Notebook, or a simple custom UI. The solution should allow users to upload the provided evidence artifacts, extract the text, and identify and classify the PII found in each file.

SUBMISSION

- A team submission, with approximately three weeks from the date of release.

For Questions

A survey will be shared

Thank you.

A closing sentence that lands the message.

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